STRATEGIC ACQUISITION PROPOSAL

Using Data to Drive Business Performance

Databases and Management Information Systems

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The Strategic Opportunity

I am not asking Cengage to bet on a new category. I am asking you to **modernize one you already lead.** Currently, to teach a business-facing database course, instructors face the "Two-Book Problem"—pairing a dense theoretical text with a vocational software manual.

Using Data to Drive Business Performance is the direct successor to the applied business-database slot currently occupied by aging texts. It replaces the fragmented experience with a unified, digital-first solution built for the analytics era.

- AI-resistant, artifact-based assessment design.
- Modular architecture isolating tool-dependent rot (cheap to revise).
- Directly addresses competitive urgency (Pearson's 2024 Azure integration).
- Competes with OER by being courseware-native for Cengage Unlimited.

1. The Category Successor

This manuscript is not a competitor to Coronel. It is the next generation of the slot *Concepts of Database Management* occupies.

Dimension	Concepts of Database Management, 10e (Cengage)	Using Data to Drive Business Performance

Copyright	2021	**2026, in live classroom use**
Tooling	Access 2019, Office 365 standards, SQL Server 2019	**SQLite → PostgreSQL/Supabase, plus full Access pathway**
SQL	Database-neutral, alongside QBE	**Executable modern SQL including CTEs, CASE, window functions**
Positioning	Applied, concise, business/teaching-focused	**Same slot, rebuilt for analytics-era business programs**

2. Cengage Portfolio Alignment (The "Two-Book Problem")

Currently, teaching an applied database course requires stitching together a dense theory text (Coronel) with a software manual (Illustrated). This forces instructors to manage two datasets, two vocabularies, and two access codes.

Dimension	Database Systems 14e (Coronel)	Illustrated Microsoft 365 1e (Beskeen)	Using Data to Drive Business Performance
Course Built For	Comprehensive database systems	Introductory Office applications	**One-semester applied database course for business undergraduates**
Pedagogical Sequence	Relational model → ER → advanced modeling → normalization → SQL begins Ch. 7	Discrete Office modules; Access is 4 of them	**Business question → data → SQL at Ch. 5 → relational model → normalization → design pivot at Ch. 9**
SQL Depth	Deep, two chapters, auto-graded MySQL labs	Effectively none; Access QBE	**SQL Foundations (Ch. 5) then Advanced SQL (Ch. 10): joins, GROUP BY, CASE, dates, window functions, views**
BI / Reporting	Ch. 13 data warehouses and BI	None	**Ch. 12: BI concepts + reporting tiers, Power BI, ETL/ELT**

Cloud / AI	Big data, NoSQL chapters	Not applicable	**Ch. 14: Supabase/PostgreSQL, APIs, row-level security, JSON, embeddings**

IS2020 Competency Crosswalk

ACM/AIS IS2020 makes Data/ Information Management a required competency area.

- **Query relational model:** Ch. 5, Ch. 10
- **Design relational databases:** Ch. 6, Ch. 7, Ch. 9
- **Program using functions/triggers:** Ch. 11, Part B
- **Secure a database:** Ch. 11 Part A; Ch. 14
- **Compare concurrency models:** Ch. 11
- **Develop non-relational models:** Ch. 14

Next Steps & Gates

Within 48 hours, I will provide:

- **The full 16-chapter outline**
- **Three representative chapters**
- **The complete Access appendix**
- **Credentials for live platform access**

"I'd rather combine my curricular analysis with Cengage's proprietary adoption data than pretend I can size this better than you can."